

KAYLEE K. WELLS

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Postdoctoral Researcher	2025 - Present
University of Delaware	
Department of Applied Economics and Statistics	

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Agricultural and Applied Economics	2025
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign	
Dissertation: "Grassland restoration and recreation in the U.S.: Valuation and its relationship to climate change beliefs and projected impacts"	
M.S. Agricultural Economics	2019
Mississippi State University - Starkville, MS	
B.S. Environmental Economics and Management	2017
Mississippi State University - Starkville, MS	
Summa Cum Laude	

CERTIFICATIONS

Mentoring Certificate	2023
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign	
Graduate College	

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Environmental and Natural Resource Economics
Secondary: Non-Market Valuation and Big Data

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

1. Netusil, N. R., S. T. M. Dissanayake, L. Lavelle, A. W. Ando, and **K. K. Wells**. 2023. "Does presentation matter? An analysis of images and text in a choice experiment of green roofs." *Q Open*, 3(1): 1-23. doi: 10.1093/qopen/qoad010

WORKING PAPERS

1. “U.S. grassland recreation under climate change: Evidence from big visitation data and weather”
2. “National value of landscape-scale grassland restoration in the U.S.” *with Amy W. Ando, Sahan T. M. Dissanayake, and Rich Iovanna*

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. “An accessible internet-based benefit transfer tool for water-related ecosystem services in the U.S.” *with Caroline Johnson, Maik Kecinski, Kent Messer, and Martin Heintzelman*
2. “Designing mitigation strategies for attribute non-attendance: A lab experiment” *with Kathy Kochanowski, Maik Kecinski, and Kent Messer*
3. “The recreational value of grasslands in the Tallgrass Prairie region of the United States”
4. “Public access, ecological integrity, and people’s heterogeneous values of grassland restoration” *with Amy W. Ando, Sahan T. M. Dissanayake, Rich Iovanna, and Sarah Cline*

EXTENSION PUBLICATIONS

1. **Wells, K. K.** and J. N. Barnes. 2017. “Local food system economies for Mississippi.” *Mississippi State University Extension*, Publication 3164.
2. **Wells, K. K.** and J. N. Barnes. 2017. “Local food system economies for Mississippi counties.” (N=82). *Mississippi State University Extension*, Publication 3164-1 to 3164-82.

PUBLISHED DATASETS

1. Martinez, C., G. Pena, and **K. K. Wells**. 2024. “Prairie Directory of North America” (2013) Entries for the Tallgrass, Mixed Grass, and Shortgrass Prairie Regions of the United States. University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign. doi: 10.13012/B2IDB-0421892_V1

PRESENTATIONS

1. Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association Annual Meeting, Red Bank, NJ, June 2026.
2. USDA-NIFA W5133 Multistate Hatch Research Group Annual Meeting, Boise, ID, February 2026.
3. Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Sessions at the Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL, November 2025.

4. Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Sessions at the Western Economic Association International Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA, June 2024.
5. Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Summer Conference, Washington, DC, May 2024.
6. USDA-NIFA W5133 Multistate Hatch Research Group Annual Meeting, Fort Collins, CO, February 2024.
7. Heartland Environmental and Resource Economics Workshop, Urbana, IL, October 2023.
8. Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Sessions at the Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Cleveland, OH, March 2023.
9. USDA-NIFA W5133 Multistate Hatch Research Group Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA, March 2023.
10. Southern Agricultural Economics Association Annual Meeting, Oklahoma City, OK, February 2023.
11. Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting, Anaheim, CA, July 2022. (poster)
12. USDA-NIFA W4133 Multistate Hatch Research Group Annual Meeting, Hood River, OR, April 2022.
13. Southern Agricultural Economics Association Annual Meeting, Birmingham, AL, February 2019.
14. Southern Agricultural Economics Association Annual Meeting, Jacksonville, FL, February 2018. (poster)
15. Mississippi State University Graduate Research Symposium, Starkville, MS, 2018. (poster)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor

August 2023 & 2024

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
 Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
 Course: M.S./MAAE Math Camp

Teaching Assistant

2020 - 2025

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
 Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
 Courses: ACE 255 The Economics of Food and Environmental Justice; ACE 310 Natural Resource Economics; ACE 500 Applied Economic Theory (grader)

Guest Lecturer	2025 - 2026
University of Delaware	
Courses: APEC 343 Environmental Economics; APEC 811 Conducting Applied Economics Research	

ADVISING & MENTORING

Kathy Kochanowski (Master's)	2025-2026
University of Delaware	
Co-adviser - Master's Thesis Committee	

Evan Smith (Undergraduate)	2023
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign	
Mentor - Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Program	

Carlos Martinez (Undergraduate)	2022
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign	
Mentor - Prairie Directory of North America Data Compilation Project	

Gisselle Pena (Undergraduate)	2022
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign	
Mentor - Prairie Directory of North America Data Compilation Project	

SERVICE

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| 1. Reviewer | 2021 - present |
| American Journal of Agricultural Economics (3 articles) Applied Economics Perspectives and Policy (1 article) Ecological Economics (1 article) Journal of Agricultural and Applied Economics (1 article) Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics (1 article) Environmental Management (1 article) Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Summer Conference 2023 (abstracts) Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Sessions at the Western Economics Association International Annual Meeting 2024 (abstracts) Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Summer Conference 2024 (abstracts) Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting 2025 (abstracts) | |
| 2. Graduate Student Representative | 2022 - 2024 |
| Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee | |
| College of Agricultural, Consumer, and Environmental Sciences | |
| University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | |
| 3. Judge (posters) | 2023 |
| Undergraduate Research Symposium | |
| University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | |

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| 4. Student Coordinator
Heartland Environmental and Resource Economics Workshop
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | 2022 |
| 5. Secretary
Graduate Student Organization
Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | 2021 - 2022 |
| 6. Student Coordinator
program in Environmental and Resource Economics (pERE) Seminar
Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | 2021 - 2023 |

AWARDS AND HONORS

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| 1. Outstanding PhD Student
Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | 2022 |
| 2. List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent by their Students
Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | Spring 2021 |
| 3. Illinois Distinguished Fellowship
Graduate College
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign | 2019 |
| 4. Three Minute Thesis Competition - People's Choice Award
Mississippi State University | 2018 |
| 5. Graduate Student Case Study Competition - 2nd Place
Agricultural and Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting | 2018 |
| 6. Social and Behavioral Sciences Poster Competition (Master's Division) - 2nd Place
Mississippi State University | 2018 |
| 7. Stephen D. Lee Scholar
Mississippi State University | 2017 |
| 8. William A. Demmer Scholar
Mississippi State University/Michigan State University | Summer 2016 |

MEDIA MENTIONS

1. Gregory, N. 2021. "Preserving the past: Study analyzes benefits of restoring cultural structures." *Mississippi Landmarks* 17(2): 6-7.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming/Software: Stata, R, LaTeX, and ArcGIS

Languages: English (native)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Agricultural and Applied Economics Association

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists

Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association

Southern Agricultural Economics Association